

Snippets

E-waste market to grow at 30 per cent

A recently published report by TechSci Research titled, 'India E-Waste Management Market Forecast & Opportunities, 2019' revealed that the country's e-waste market is expected to grow at a CAGR of around 30.6 per cent during 2014-19. The report stated that the southern and western regions are the largest contributors to the country's e-waste market.

Renewable Energy installed capacity stands at 12.95%

The India Renewable Energy Status Report 2014 released at the Green Summit 2014 in Bengaluru has revealed that the total installed capacity of green/renewable energy stands at 32,269.6 MW, or is approximately 12.95 per cent of the potential available in the country as on 31st March. The overall renewable energy potential from various sources in India is approximately 249,188 MW.

Karnataka's revised solar policy approved

The Karnataka government has cleared the revised solar energy policy for the state. Under the policy, farmers will be encouraged to set up solar power plants to produce solar energy up to 3 MW and sell it to electricity companies. The solar energy will be purchased by the companies at a tariff fixed by the Karnataka Energy Regulatory Commission. The farmers will get financial support to install solar plants on their land. The farmers will also be able to rent their land to investors for solar power generation at a rate fixed by the government.

Renesas' new subsidiary in India

Renesas Electronics Singapore recently spun off its India operations into a new subsidiary, for which Sunil Dhar has been appointed as the managing director. "Since 2011, we have been operating via our branch offices in Bengaluru, Delhi and Mumbai. In the last three years, Renesas has gained significant traction in the Indian market. Setting up a wholly-owned subsidiary will allow us to expand our footprint to accelerate business growth," says Dhar.

CeramTec opens office in India

CeramTec, the manufacturer of technical high-performance ceramics for electronics and many other applications, has opened an office in Panaji, Goa. The company deals in a variety of highly-specialised ceramic materials where other materials, such as plastic or metal, cannot withstand the extremely high loads.

means to an end, after a while once the industry gets on its own two feet and reaches a certain scale, then those duties can be scaled back." Goel added.

Tablet market in India drops

The tablet market may be growing all over the world, but India does not seem to play a big role in it. According to a recent report released by the IDC, the Indian tablet market has fallen by 32.8 per cent year-on-year in the first quarter of 2014. The report said that only 780,000 tablet shipments were seen in the quarter.

Further, the IDC reports that a lack of new buyers and the norms for compliance with the Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) are responsible for the drop in the sales of tablets. The lack of a decent budget is also the reason for the drop in the sales of Android tablets in the country.

The IDC report also noted that Samsung is the top tablet vendor in India, followed by Apple and Micro-

max. Surprisingly, the three companies were followed by Datawind in the fourth place. This is perhaps because of the absence of many tablet sellers in the country. This rating is of course in terms of the shipments received by each company and not in terms of the actual number of tablets sold.

Setting up of Electronics Commission proposed

Electronics industry representatives and semiconductor associations have urged newly appointed Minister for Communications and IT, Ravi Shankar Prasad, to set up an independent Electronics Commission, much like the Telecom Commission, to address all matters pertaining to the electronic design and manufacturing sector. The first of its kind Commission will play a key role in tackling all problems the industry is facing, insisted the representatives.

"The commission will include representatives from the industry as well. The ministry is very positive towards this proposal," M.N. Vidyashankar, president of the Indian Electronic and Semiconductor Association (IESA), was quoted as saying. The proposed commission would also oversee hastening of the progress of electronic clusters being set up in different parts of the country.

According to a Frost & Sullivan report, the electronic design and manufacturing sector in India is expected to grow at 9.9 per cent (CAGR) to touch US\$ 94.2 billion by the year 2015. This is twice the growth rate of the global ESDM market. But, at present, nearly 65 per cent of the demand for electronic products is met by imports. Sadly, even the 35 per cent balance that is made in India is primarily low-value-added manufacturing.

Philips re-entering mobile handset market

Philips could not stay away from the charm of Indian mobile handset market for long and has made a re-entry in the market. The new range of mobile phones from Philips include both smartphones and feature phones.

According to a company spokesperson, the Philips brand of feature phones and smartphones have been launched in India by Sang Fei Consumer Communications Co., a joint venture between Royal Dutch Philips Electronics and Shenzhen SED Industry Co. Sang Fei has launched these phones about seven years after China Electronics Corporation (CEC), the parent group of Sang Fei, acquired the global mobile phone business of Philips. The acquisition happened in February 2007.

According to the company's website, Sang Fei has come up with a new series of Philips mobile phones. The India business of these phones will be headed by SS Bassi, Sang Fei's head of SAARC operations, who has worked with Lenovo India and Reliance Communications in the past. Philips had a range for feature phones in India, till the time of acquisition. The company slowly disappeared and the space was filled by the home-grown manufacturers.

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